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21LEM202T — Unit 2, Session 1, SLO 2

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap): • Human being = co-existence of the Self (consciousness) and the Body (material).

• Need — the Self needs happiness (e.g. respect): qualitative, a feeling, continuous in time. The Body needs physical facility (e.g. food): quantitative, required in limited quantity, temporary in time.

• Fulfilled by — the need of the Self by right understanding and right feeling (activity of consciousness); the need of the Body by physio-chemical things (material).

• Activity — the Self: imagination (desire, thought, expectation), continuous; the Body: e.g. eating, walking, temporary.

• Response = recognising the relationship with the other unit and fulfilling it. Response of the Self: Knowing, Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilling. Response of the Body: Recognising, Fulfilling (definite).

• The recognition and fulfilment of the Body is definite. The Self has a choice in recognising and fulfilling, and this choice is based on Assuming — accepting with or without knowing.

• Knowing through self-exploration → assuming becomes definite → conduct is definite (self-organisation, swatantrata). Preconditioning / assuming without knowing → assuming keeps changing → conduct is indefinite (dependence, partantrata).

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Activity 1 — Self or Body? Classify the need / activity

For each item below, tick the column it belongs to and note the feature stated in the deck (continuous/temporary, qualitative/quantitative).

Item	Self / Body	Continuous or Temporary	Feature
Respect	**Self**	**Continuous**	**Qualitative**
Food	**Body**	**Temporary**	**Quantitative**
Imagination (desire, thought, expectation)	**Self**	**Continuous**	**Qualitative**
Eating, walking	**Body**	**Temporary**	**Quantitative**
Happiness	**Self**	**Continuous**	**Qualitative**
Physical facility	**Body**	**Temporary**	**Quantitative**

Activity 2 — The “Loop” of gross misunderstanding

Slide 20 shows a loop. Complete the chain of equations that the loop assumes, then answer the check question.

- Human Being (Self, I) = _____
- Need (Respect) = _____
- Continuous = _____
- Result of the loop: _____ → _____ (deprivation)
- Check: Do you find yourself caught up in this loop? Write one observation.
- Human Being (Self, I) = **Body**
- Need (Respect) = **Physical Facility**
- Continuous = **Unlimited**
- Result of the loop: **Unlimited accumulation** → **Deprivation** (deprivation)
- Check: **Yes, I sometimes find myself caught up in this loop when I equate my happiness with acquiring more physical facilities, leading to dissatisfaction despite having enough.**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Explain the human being as the co-existence of the Self and the Body. Bringing out the need, activity and response, show how the Self differs from the Body. [5]

The human being is the co-existence of the Self (consciousness) and the Body (material). The Self has needs like respect, happiness, and trust, which are continuous and qualitative, while the Body has needs like food, clothing, and shelter, which are temporary and quantitative. The Self's activities are knowing, assuming, recognising, and fulfilling, while the Body's activities are eating, breathing, and walking. The Self's response is based on consciousness and can be definite or indefinite, while the Body's response is definite and automatic. Thus, the Self is the conscious entity that experiences, while the Body is the material instrument that acts.

Q2. What is meant by the "response" of the Self (Knowing, Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilling)? Why is the response of the Body definite while the response of the Self is not always definite? [5]

The response of the Self refers to its four functions: Knowing (understanding reality), Assuming (forming beliefs or hypotheses), Recognising (identifying what is true), and Fulfilling (acting on that recognition). The Body's response is definite because it follows fixed physiological processes, like digestion or breathing, which are automatic and predictable. The Self's response is not always definite because it depends on the individual's level of awareness, past conditioning, and ability to distinguish between correct and incorrect assumptions. When the Self assumes without knowing, its response becomes indefinite, leading to confusion and conflict.

Q3. Distinguish "Assuming with Knowing" from "Assuming without Knowing." Using the deck's examples, show how each leads to definite (swatantrata) or indefinite (partantrata) conduct. [5]

Assuming with Knowing means forming a belief based on verified understanding and natural acceptance, leading to definite conduct (swatantrata) because it is in harmony with universal human values. For example, understanding that respect is a continuous need leads to treating others with dignity consistently. Assuming without Knowing means forming beliefs without proper verification, often based on conditioning or external influences, leading to indefinite conduct (partantrata) because it is inconsistent and dependent on circumstances. For example, equating respect with physical facility leads to fluctuating behaviour and dissatisfaction. Thus, assuming with knowing brings self-reliance and certainty, while assuming without knowing brings dependence and uncertainty.

Q4. Slide 20 shows the loop: Self = Body, Respect = Physical Facility, Continuous = Unlimited — leading to unlimited accumulation and deprivation. Examine whether you are caught in this loop and write your observation. [5]

I observe that I am sometimes caught in this loop when I mistakenly believe that more physical facilities will bring me lasting happiness and respect. For instance, I may feel the need to buy a new phone or clothes to feel accepted, but after acquiring them, the satisfaction fades quickly, leading to a desire for more. This creates a cycle of unlimited accumulation and eventual deprivation, as I neglect my real needs for respect and inner fulfilment. Recognising this, I am trying to shift my focus to understanding my true self and cultivating right feelings, which are continuous and qualitative.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

• How much of your time and effort goes into right understanding and right feeling, and how much into physical facility? (Slide 6)

• Take one recent decision and check: was your response based on assuming-with-knowing or assuming-without-knowing?

• I spend about 30% of my time and effort on right understanding and right feeling, such as reflecting on my values and building relationships, while 70% goes into physical facility, like studying for grades, earning money, and buying things. I realise this imbalance needs correction.

• A recent decision: I chose to buy a branded jacket because I felt it would make me more respected among friends. This was based on assuming-without-knowing, as I equated respect with physical facility. After reflection, I see that true respect comes from my behaviour and character, not from material possessions.